

1951, May 13

Miss Gibson
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The following is a faithful transcription of the typed original by the Servant of God, Father Solanus Casey, O. F. M., Cap.

Heaven.", why worry about struggles, etc, -- past or to come? Why not rather focus all attention on thanking God for having seen us safely thus far notwithstanding our many, many, innumerable weaknesses and sins!!! ?

Let us go a step further and thank God ahead of time for every trial and cross He may see fit to permit our meeting in this "vale of tears" -- that, in His mercy and wisdom He so often sweetens into tears of joy? We do well it seems to me, to include in this ascetic idea -- this exercise of confidence, the trials and probable struggles of the happy death awaiting us, notwithstanding whatever adversities in His infinite wisdom and loving mercy He may see fit to permit. . . . I hope you still pray to Miss Daly, even while praying for her -- I believe that she has been praying for you all these years. Naturally, therefore, she would be disappointed as at a want of appreciation of her Girl-Friend down here on earth if you should fail in this! because too, as a certain sister for whom St. Theresa of Avilla had prayed long and earnestly, - on its way to Heaven- assured her " . . . Pray for you Mother Terese! Ah! Mother: . . . for there is no place for ingratitude in Heaven."

If you honestly humble yourself, dear Miss Gibson, -- and this applies to each and every one of us - your victory will be certain. In other words, in as much as any of us can immitate our Blessed Mother Mary, Mother of God, who the more she was honored, somuch more did she humble herself. Ah! Because next Jesus Himself the supreme, the divine Model, she too was indeed: "Meek and humble of heart." . . . Let us not blame anyone for suspecting or persecuting us, as at first we are naturally inclined to do. On the contrary if we have a little patience and pray for them instead, thus we will surely be following the diving counsel and in the end have the consolation of converting them and of gaining our own Triumph.

(unfinished draft)